

AVERY (AJ) SCHWARTZ

631-327-0707 · avschwartz@ucsd.edu

Researcher and educator with 5+ years of experience translating behavioral science into actionable insight for diverse audiences. Background spans experimental design, data science, and teaching, with a consistent focus on gathering, synthesizing, and communicating research findings accurately for varied audiences. Detail-oriented and comfortable learning new tools and data systems, with a strong track record of maintaining data quality and integrity across concurrent projects.

SKILLS

Research & Analysis: Experimental design, behavioral studies, survey design (Qualtrics), mixed methods, prospect and background research and synthesis

Data Management: Data entry, validation, and quality control; reproducible and documented data pipelines; R (tidyverse, lme4, ggplot2), Python, WhisperX

Communication & Teaching: Public speaking, curriculum & lesson design, technical writing, cross-audience translation of research findings

Tools: Notion, Zotero, Google Suite, Microsoft Office, Google Sites

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher — Language Production Lab, UC San Diego

2024 – Present

- Design and run studies examining how the constraints of video-call communication (e.g., Zoom delays) shape listeners' judgments of speakers — research with direct relevance to remote work, education, and telehealth contexts.
- Build end-to-end data pipelines for behavioral and audio data, including automated transcription and LLM-assisted analysis across multiple model APIs.
- Analyze multi-variable datasets in R; maintain reproducible, documented codebases and ensure accuracy and consistency across collaborative projects.

Research Technician — Speech & Hearing Lab, Washington University in St. Louis

2020 – 2024

- Designed and led an independent honors thesis on input variability and second language vocabulary acquisition, from study design through analysis and public presentation.
- Collected and analyzed behavioral data across multiple concurrent studies on language learning and working memory.
- Recruited and trained junior research assistants in experimental procedures and data standards.

Research Technician — Cognitive Control & Psychopathology Lab, Washington University in St. Louis

2021 – 2024

- Collected and processed EEG and fMRI data for multi-site, grant-funded cognitive control research.
- Maintained detailed processing logs and participant metadata; supported senior researchers preparing data for publication.

TEACHING & PUBLIC COMMUNICATION EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant — UC San Diego

2024 – Present

- Taught experimental design, data management, and statistical analysis to undergraduates in Research Methods in Psychology.
- Delivered a guest lecture on language production and supported instruction in Psychology of Language, translating technical psycholinguistic concepts for a non-specialist audience.
- Also taught Memory and Amnesia, Psychology and the Law, and Criminology; graded and gave feedback on written work for large lecture courses.
- Led a student journal club on language production, mentoring undergraduate research assistants in reading and discussing primary research.

SELECTED PROJECTS & PRESENTATIONS

- “Some LLMs Just Can't Help Using What They Know” — Poster to be presented at the Psychonomic Society Annual Meeting, 2026.
- Misattribution of Delay in Turn-Taking on Speaker Judgments — Master's Thesis, UCSD. Investigated how Zoom-induced audio delays cause listeners to misattribute hesitation to speakers, lowering confidence ratings even when speech content was identical. Presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology conference (2026).
- Input Variability and Second Language Vocabulary Acquisition — Honors Thesis, WashU. Examined how varied input exposure affects vocabulary learning outcomes; presented at WashU undergraduate research symposium.

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego	2024 – Present
• MA in Psychology (2025); PhD coursework in Experimental Psychology · GPA: 3.9	
Washington University in St. Louis	2019 – 2023
• BA in Cognitive Neuroscience (Honors), Minor in Art · Cum Laude · GPA: 3.8	

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Exhibit Floor Volunteer — Fleet Science Center, San Diego	2026 – Present
• Engage with museum visitors of all ages on the exhibit floor, translating hands-on science concepts into accessible, engaging explanations for a general public audience.	
Co-Founder & Co-President — CARD/BOARD, Washington University in St. Louis	2021 – 2022
• Founded and ran a campus board game library; grew membership to 100+, managing inventory, volunteers, and cross-org partnerships.	